ReturnWise

E-Commerce Return Intelligence Report

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1. Executive Summary

This report analyzes 8,000 orders from the e-commerce platform, covering 594 customers and 50 products across 6 categories. The overall return rate is 11.63% based on 7,591 eligible orders (excluding cancelled orders). Total revenue amounts to ■48,163,248.75 with an average order value of ■6,020.41.

Metric	Value
Total Orders	8,000
Return Rate	11.63%
Total Revenue	■48,163,248.75
Avg Order Value	■6,020.41
Items Returned	883
Total Refund Amount	■2,289,755.42
Cancellation Rate	5.11%

2. Dataset Overview

The dataset consists of 5 related tables: customers (600 records), orders (8000 records), order items (16418 records), products (50 records), and returns (883 records). All joins are clean with zero unmatched keys.

Order dates range from 2024-01-01 to 2025-12-31.

Note: The dataset does not contain delivery date or seller identifier fields. Delivery and seller analyses are adapted accordingly.

3. Data Quality Findings

Data quality report not available.

4. Key Insights

Category Return Rates

Category	Total Items	Returned	Return Rate
Electronics	2830	161	5.69%
Books & Stationery	3959	219	5.53%
Home & Kitchen	1776	98	5.52%
Beauty & Personal Care	2132	112	5.25%
Sports & Fitness	2512	130	5.18%
Fashion	3209	163	5.08%

Return Reasons

Reason	Count	Percentage
Better Price Found Elsewhere	136	15.4%
Wrong Item Delivered	132	14.95%
Changed Mind	131	14.84%
Size/Fit Issue	126	14.27%
Quality Issue	123	13.93%
Not as Described	119	13.48%
Product Damaged	116	13.14%

5. Discount Impact Analysis

Discount Level	Total Items	Returns	Return Rate
0%	7426	405	5.45%
5%	3240	165	5.09%
10%	2513	128	5.09%
15%	1935	106	5.48%
20%	1304	79	6.06%

8. Recommendations

1. Investigate High Returns in Electronics

Finding: Electronics has the highest return rate at 5.69%

Metric: 161 returned items out of 2830 sold

Action: Review product descriptions, quality checks, and customer feedback for this category

Evidence: Based on 2830 order items — statistically meaningful sample

2. Address 'Better Price Found Elsewhere' Returns

Finding: 'Better Price Found Elsewhere' is the most common return reason (15.4%)

Metric: 136 returns

Action: Implement targeted interventions based on the specific reason type

Evidence: Consistent across 136 return instances

3. Overall Return Rate Monitoring

Finding: Overall return rate is 11.63%

Metric: 883 returns out of 7591 eligible orders

Action: Set up automated alerts for return rate changes by category and time period

Evidence: Baseline established from full dataset analysis

4. Reduce Refund Costs

Finding: Total refund amount is ■2,289,755.42

Metric: Average refund: ■2,593.15 per returned item

Action: Focus return reduction efforts on high-value product categories

Evidence: Based on 883 returned items

9. Methodology & Limitations

Return Rate Calculation: Returned eligible orders ÷ Total eligible orders × 100. Eligible orders include Delivered, Returned, and Refunded statuses. Cancelled orders are excluded.

Limitations: (1) No delivery date fields available — delivery delay analysis not possible. (2) No seller identifiers — seller performance uses category-level proxy. (3) No product size field — size-related analysis not possible. (4) Correlation does not imply causation — discount and return associations are observational.